

Why the brand looks the way it does

A short, honest record of the thinking — so the direction can be defended in the room, not just admired.

What the brief told us

HexP is a **compliance-first, AI-native “university OS”** — one connected system from admission to placement. The buyer is a senior, skeptical, non-technical administrator (Registrar, Controller of Exams, VC) who already believes **vendors overpromise** and that **change is painful**. The brief asked for a tone that **reassures rather than disrupts**.

What we learned

“Compliance AI” isn’t ownable — Kramah and Creatrix already claim it. Our two defensible advantages are the **built-in placement module** and the **fees-to-exam-eligibility link**. From there, one principle drove every visual decision: **structure carries credibility; colour and imagery carry warmth**.

Why warmth

Warmth isn’t decoration — it’s the only tone that fits who buys this and what we’re selling them.

The buyer is a human running a human institution. Registrars and VCs are educators, not IT buyers; their world is students, faculty and futures. Cold, systems-first design talks past them. Warmth says we see the university as people, not a system to optimise.

It matches the product’s own promise. HexP’s pitch is “give your people their time back — stop managing systems, start building the institution.” That promise is about restoring the human. A cold brand would contradict it; a warm one is the proof of it.

It disarms their one stated fear — that vendors overpromise. To this buyer, slick and cold reads as flash, the exact pattern they distrust. Warm, calm and considered reads as honest and human-run.

Why rare is the advantage, not the risk

We’re not trying to look familiar — we’re trying to look like the premium choice.

Indian edu-tech is cluttered, loud, generic-blue and cheap-looking. Looking **familiar** would mean looking like that. A warm, calm, considered brand does the opposite: it stands out and signals

premium, international-grade, cared-for — which flatters the status motivations in our segments (Big Guns protecting elite status; Challengers wanting to rise fast). And it's a **classic** kind of distinctive — heritage serif, warm neutrals — so it reads established, not experimental. Distinctive, not disruptive.

Why not only warmth

Warmth earns trust. Structure earns confidence.

The same “will it actually deliver?” fear means the brand must also feel rigorous. So **structure, precision and real product screens** carry the credibility, while colour and imagery carry the warmth — roughly **70% human, 30% rigour**. A division of labour, not a vibe.

The system, in short

Ground — warm near-white; warmth as undertone, not brightness.

Accents — muted sage, clay, rose, blue; used to code modules and status, never as decoration.

Primary — near-black; credible and un-trendy.

Type — Bilena (old-style serif) on headlines for academic warmth and hand-made character, readable at every size; Inter on body and UI for the clarity ERP buyers trust.

Finish — flat colour, no gradients; precise, and it doesn't date.

Illustration — loose, hand-drawn ink line, one muted accent, dignified scenes — Mailchimp's hand, not its humour.

Texture — grain, confluence and warm wash, in warm zones only, always subtle; never on the product/data layer.

LOCKED SO FAR

- Warm near-white ground
- Near-black primary
- Muted flat accents
- Bilena headlines + Inter UI
- Flat — no gradients
- Structure serious · colour human
- Loose hand-drawn line illustration
- Texture: grain · confluence · wash (warm zones only)

OPEN / NEXT

- A real primary-colour exploration
- Duotone photography (where a real face earns it)
- Name architecture (HexP / Techademy / AlphaRecrew)